CONFOEDERATIO,
RESEARCH DIVISION (CRD).

GALICIA, VOLHYNIA AND THE SOUTH-WESTERN RUS LANDS

Population and Settlement from the Dniester Farming Cultures to the Kingdom of Rus

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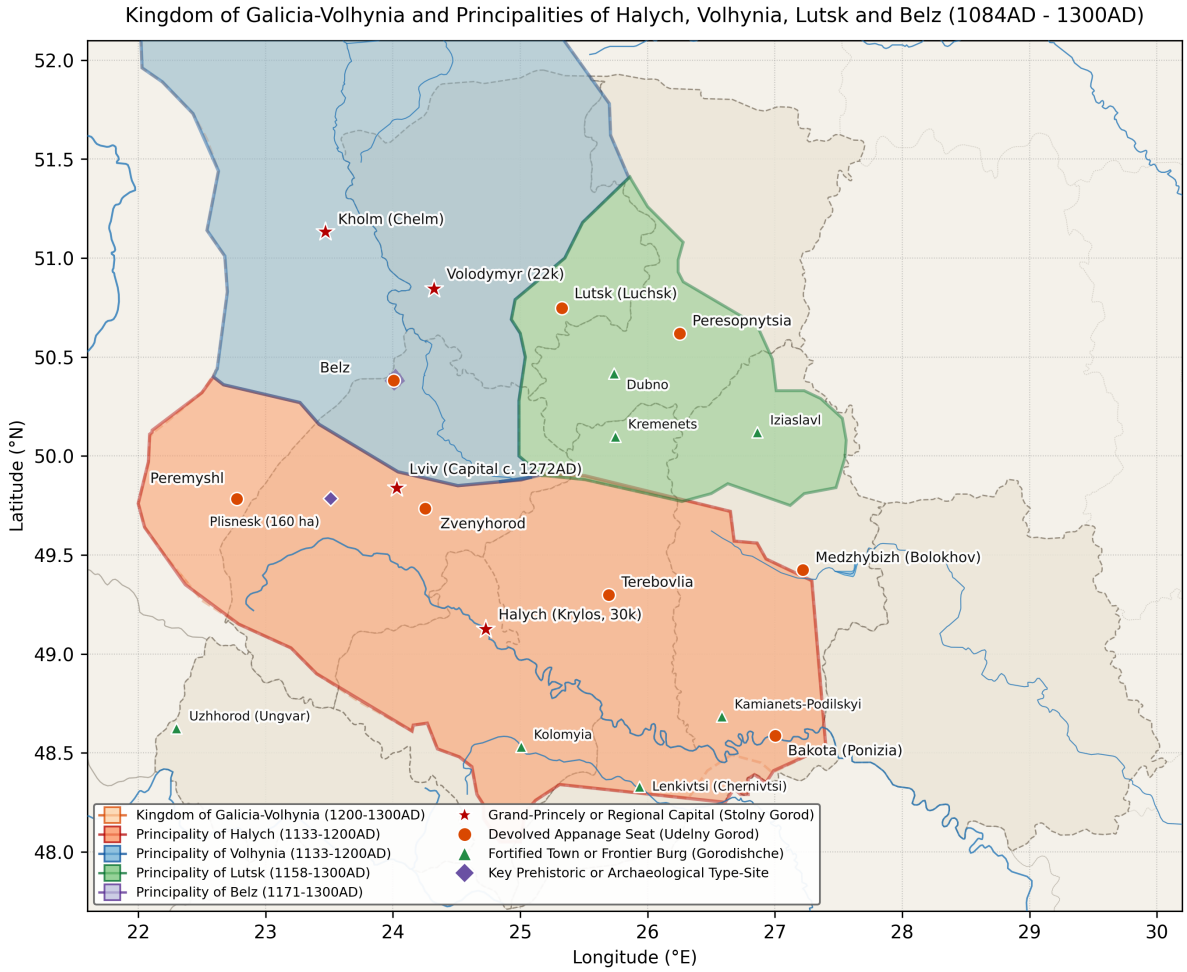


Figure 1. Approximate boundaries of the Romanovichi realm (~176,2k km^2), showing the Halych capital on the Upper Dniester (30k in 1200AD), the Volhynian capitals at Volodymyr (22k) and Kholm, the unstormed cliff fortresses of Kremenets and Danyliv, and the fortified towns of the Dniester, San and Bug basins.

Abstract

Sheltered by the Carpathian arc in the south-west and the Pripyat marshes in the north, the loess plateaus of Galicia, Volhynia and Podolia (~176,2k km^2) formed one of the most densely settled regions of pre-Mongol Eastern Europe [1][2][3]. Before Batu Khan's campaign of 1240-1241, South-Western Rus passed through four main phases of population growth. Beginning from a Late Palaeolithic base of 16k in

the sheltered Dniester canyons (10000BC) and 65k in the early farming villages of 5000BC, the Trypillia-Cucuteni Eneolithic culture of the Dniester, Prut and Bug plateaus reached 260k around 3500BC, centred on promontory settlements at Bilche-Zolote (Verteba), Koshylivtsi, Bodaki, Zalishchyky and Stina [4]. In the Early Iron Age (c. 500BC), the Vysotska and Early Scythian West Podolian hillforts supported 490k inhabitants around the 110 ha rampart stronghold at Nemyriv, Severynivka and Hryhorivka [5], followed in the Roman era (c. 300AD) by an expansion to 680k across the Chernyakhov, Lipitsa, Przeworsk and Carpathian Tumuli cultures [6][7].

During the Kievan and appanage periods (1000AD - 1200AD), 350 fortified towns (*gorodishcha*) and surrounding open villages supported 1,15M inhabitants in 1000AD, 1,46M in 1100AD and 1,82M in 1200AD [8][9][10]. When the Mongols stormed Volodymyr, Halych, Zvenyhorod, Iziaslavl and Kolodyazhyn in the winter of 1240-1241, the regional population dropped by nearly a third to 1,24M in 1250AD. Unlike the middle Dnieper steppe borderland, however, the western principalities kept their political independence and mountain strongholds: under King Daniel Romanovich (crowned 1253AD), Lev Danilovich and Yuri I Lvovich, growth around the new royal capitals of Kholm and Lviv restored the population of the Kingdom of Rus to 1,38M by 1300AD [11][12].

Background

Geographically, the region spans nine modern western and right-bank Ukrainian oblasts (~176,2k km^2) across the Upper and Middle Dniester, Western Bug, San, Styr, Horyn, Upper Pripyat, Upper Prut and Upper Tisza river basins. Historically, this territory formed the south-western march of Kievan Rus (981-1133AD) and later divided into the Rostislavichi Galician principalities, the Monomakhovichi and Romanovichi Volhynian principalities and the unified Kingdom of Galicia-Volhynia (1199-1341AD).

The Rostislavichi Galician principalities (49,6k km^2 across Lvivska, Ivano-Frankivska, Ternopilska and the San-Cherven strip) comprised the principalities of Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod and Terebovlia (1133-1142AD), which were united into the Principality of Halych (1141-1200AD) by Vladimirko Volodarevich and Yaroslav Osmomysl around the 200 ha urban complex of Halych (*Krylos*, 30k inhabitants at 1200AD) [10][12][13]. To the north, the Volhynian principalities (40,19k km^2 across Volynska, Rivnenska and the Left-Bank Western Bug) comprised the Principality of Volhynia centred on Volodymyr (*Vladimir-Volynsky*, 75 ha, 22k at 1200AD) and later Kholm (*Chelm*, 8k in 1240AD and 12k in 1300AD), the Principality of Lutsk (1158-1324AD) across the Styr, Ikva and Horyn (*Pogoryrina*) basins (Lutsk, Peresopnytsia, Dorogobuzh, Kremenets and Iziaslavl) and the Principality of Belz (1171-1367AD, Belz and Busk) [2][3][14]. To the south and east, Ponizia (Podolia), Shipenitskaya Zemlya, Transcarpathia and the southern frontier marches (86,41k km^2 across Khmelnytska, Vinnytska, Chernivetska and Zakarpatska) covered the Middle Dniester canyon of Ponizia (Bakota, Kamianets, Ushitsa, Kalius and Kuchelmin), the Western Bolokhov Land (Medzhybizh and Bozhsky), Shipenitskaya Zemlya in Northern Bukovina (Lenkivtsi or *Chern* on the Prut and Khotyn) and Subcarpathian Rus (Uzhhorod and Mukachevo), with dynastic ties extending to the Pontic-Crimean outposts of Tmutarakan and Mangup (*Theodoro*) [15][16][17].

Results

Prehistoric and Iron Age Settlement

Upper Palaeolithic, Neolithic and Trypillia-Cucuteni Eneolithic

Unlike the glaciated northern forest basins of European Russia, the deep limestone canyons of the Middle Dniester, Prut and upper Volhynian uplands offered sheltered Ice Age hunting grounds throughout the late Pleistocene (10000BC) [18]. Multilayered open-air camps at Molodova I and Molodova V, Korman IV, Babin I and Voronovitsa along the Dniester canyon, together with the Korolevo sequence on the Tisza in Transcarpathia and Kulychivka (at Kremenets) in Volhynia, preserve Magdalenian and Epigravettian mammoth- and reindeer-hunter camps supporting a 10000BC regional population of 16k (range 8k - 28k) [18].

During the Early Holocene (6500BC - 4500BC), indigenous Mesolithic fisher-foragers of the Bug-Dniester Culture (*Soroky*, *Bazkiv Ostriv*, *Pechera* and *Sokoltsi* on the Southern Bug) adopted early ceramics and domesticated plants through contact with Linearbandkeramik (LBK) farmers advancing along the Carpathian piedmont into the Upper Dniester and Western Bug loess terraces (*Nezvysko*, *Torskie*, *Zymne*, *Kotiv* and *Rivne*) [4]. By 5000BC, permanent LBK longhouse villages and Bug-Dniester riverine settlements supported 65k inhabitants.

Between 4200BC and 3000BC, the Dniester-Prut-Southern Bug plateaus and southern Volhynian uplands formed the western heartland of the Trypillia-Cucuteni Culture (Stages BI-BII and CI-CII), with over 800 documented settlements [4]. Along the Upper and Middle Dniester loess terraces, multiphase promontory settlements and ritual cave sites flourished at Bilche-Zolote (Verteba Cave, 2,5k), Koshylivtsi-Oboz (2,5k), Zalishchyky (2,2k), Nezvysko (1,8k), Horodnytsia (1,8k), Buchach (1,6k) and Polivanov Yar (1,5k) [4]. In the Volhynian-Horyn flint-mining and workshop zone, Late Trypillian (CI-CII) fortified promontory settlements at Bodaki on the Horyn (2k), Zymne, Khoriv and Lystvyn mined and exported Turonian dark flint blades across the Carpathian-Pontic region [4]. Further east along the Podolian and Southern Bug corridor, large concentric-plan settlements at Stina (3k), Nemyriv (2,2k) and Klishchiv (2k) linked the Dniester valley and the Bug-Dnieper mega-site zone.

By 3500BC, the regional population reached 260k (range 180k - 360k). During the Early and Middle Bronze Age (2500BC - 1200BC), pastoral Corded Ware (*Pidkarpatska kultura shnurovoi keramiky*), Komariv (centred on *Komariv* near Halych, working sub-Carpathian salt springs and trading in Transylvanian bronze) and Noua communities expanded across the Carpathian foothills and Volhynian forest-steppe, raising the population to 310k in 1500BC [10].

Scythian Hillforts and the Chernyakhov Horizon

In the Early Iron Age (700BC - 300BC), the Hallstatt-influenced Vysotska Culture (Lvivska and Ternopilska oblasts) and the Early Scythian West Podolian Group along the Middle Dniester and Southern Bug built large earthen-rampart hillforts [5]. The largest regional stronghold was the Nemyriv Hillfort (*Nemyrivske horodyshche*, 48,97°N, 28,84°E), enclosed by 9 m-high ramparts (5,5 km perimeter) encompassing 110 ha, with Milesian and Attic black-glazed pottery (sixth to fifth centuries BC) and an estimated population of 4,5k [5]. Together with the neighbouring hillforts at Severynivka (2,5k), Hryhorivka (2,2k), Chornoliska and Vysotske, the region supported 490k inhabitants in 500BC.

During the Roman Imperial period (100AD - 400AD), the Lipitsa (Dacian-Thracian salt-workers of the Upper Dniester), Przeworsk, Wielbark (along the Western Bug and Styr), Carpathian Tumuli and Zubrytska cultures merged in the third and fourth centuries AD into the agricultural expansion of the Chernyakhov Culture [6][7]. Excavations at Ripniv II, Lepesivka, Bovshiv, Demianiv, Cherneliv-Ruskyi, Bakota and Sokol record heavy iron-shod plough cultivation, rotary querns, glass-working kilns and Roman denarius hoards, raising the regional population to an antique peak of 680k at 300AD [6].

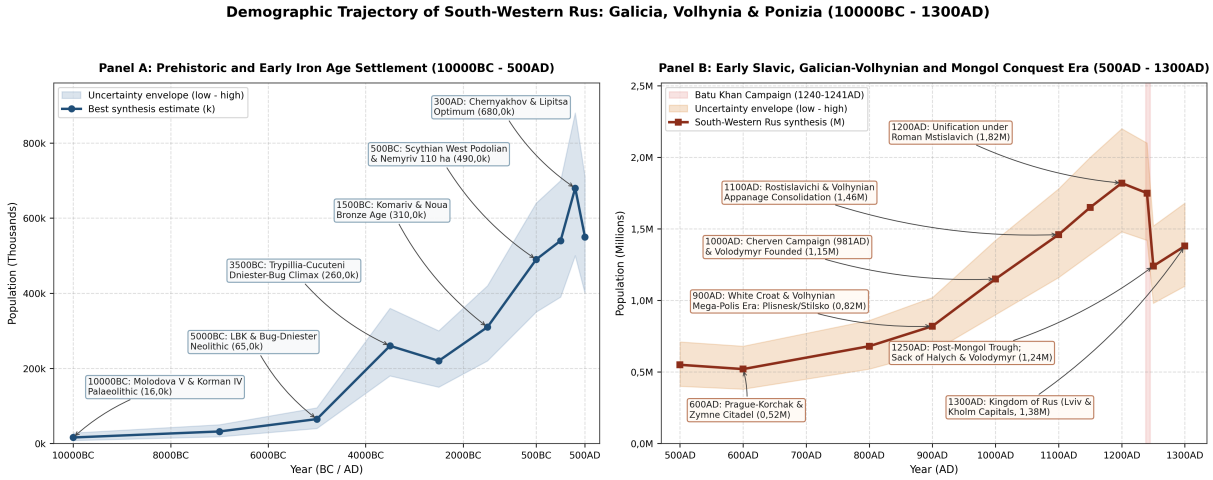


Figure 2. Shaded bands indicate uncertainty ranges around the central estimate. Prehistoric growth peaked during the Trypillia-Cucuteni farming expansion (260k at 3500BC) and the Roman-era Chernyakhov culture (680k at 300AD); medieval numbers reached 1,82M in 1200AD before Batu Khan's 1240-1241AD winter campaign reduced the population to 1,24M in 1250AD.

Date	Galicia Core (Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod & Terebovlia)	Volhynia, Lutsk & Belz	Ponizia (Podolia) & Bolokhov West	Bukovina & Transcarpathia	Regional Total (Range)
10000BC	6k	4k	4k	2k	16k (8 - 28k)
5000BC	26k	18k	14k	7k	65k (40 - 95k)
3500BC	105k	65k	62k	28k	260k (180 - 360k)
1500BC	125k	85k	65k	35k	310k (220 - 420k)
500BC	195k	125k	120k	50k	490k (350 - 640k)
300AD	275k	180k	155k	70k	680k (500 - 880k)
600AD	215k	145k	105k	55k	520k (380 - 680k)
800AD	340k	215k	80k	45k	680k (520 - 860k)
900AD	415k	260k	95k	50k	820k (640 - 1,02M)

Table 1. Sub-regional population estimates and total uncertainty ranges (in thousands) from the Late Palaeolithic Dniester canyon camps (10000BC) to the Luka-Raikovetska tribal hillforts (900AD).

Early Slavic and Galician-Volhynian Era

Prague-Korchak Strongholds and Tribal Centres

Following the post-Chernyakhov transition (fifth and sixth centuries AD), the Upper Dniester, Western Bug and Styr-Horyn basins became the core of the Early Slavic Prague-Korchak Culture (520k regional population at 600AD) [7][19]. At Zymne on the Luha River near Volodymyr (50,8°N, 24,33°E), V. V. Aulikh excavated a sixth- to seventh-century AD timber-palisaded citadel (1,5k inhabitants) yielding non-ferrous jewellery moulds, iron weapons, silvered belt mounts and Byzantine coins of Justinian I and Justin II (527-578AD), destroyed during the Avar wars against the *Duliby* [19]. Contemporaneous early Slavic settlements stood at Ripniv, Bovshiv, Zelene, Krylos and Rashkiv [7].

During the Luka-Raikovetska tribal era (680k in 800AD; 820k in 900AD), the White Croats, Volhynians, Buzhany and Tivertsi built large multi-part hillforts (*gorodishcha*): Plisnesk (160 ha across seven defensive rampart lines, 6k in 900AD) [20], Stilsko (200 ha enclosure on the Kolodnytsia with 10 km of ramparts, 7k in 900AD), Old Halych (*Krylos*, 4,5k in 900AD), Revne (2,5k), Volyn (*Grudek*, 3,5k), Cherven (3k), Busk (*Buzhsk*, 2,5k) and Peremyshl (3,5k) [2][10][16]. After Grand Prince Vladimir the Great's 981AD Cherven campaign, his 992AD Croat campaign and the foundation of Volodymyr (988AD), regional population reached 1,15M at 1000AD [2].

Devolved Principalities

Between 1084AD (when the Rostislavichi brothers established separate rule in Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod and Terebovlia, ratified at the 1097AD Council of Liubech) and 1199AD (when Roman Mstislavich united Galicia and Volhynia), South-Western Rus developed the densest network of fortified towns in Kievan Rus, with 350 excavated *gorodishcha* catalogued by A. V. Kuza and B. P. Tomenchuk: 92 in Halych and Terebovlia, 64 in Peremyshl and Zvenyhorod, 78 in Volhynia and Belz, 68 in Lutsk and Pogoryrina and 48 in Ponizia and Bukovina [9][10][21].

In the Galician lands, the Principality of Halych (1133-1200AD) was unified by Vladimirko Volodarevich (1141-1144AD) and Yaroslav Osmomysl (1153-1187AD). Its capital at Halych (*Krylos*) encompassed a 200 ha settlement cluster along the Lukva and Dniester featuring the white-stone Dormition Cathedral (1157AD) and St Panteleimon Church, housing 30k inhabitants at 1200AD [10][12][13], supported by the sub-Carpathian salt-boiling centres of Kolomyia (3,5k), Zudechev (Zhydachiv, 3k), Sudova Vyshnia (2,5k), Drohobych (2,2k), Dolyna (2k) and the rock fortress of Tustan (1,2k). To the west, the Principality of Peremyshl centred on Peremyshl (*Przemysl*, a 38 ha *detinets* with a stone rotunda, *palatium* and *posad*, 9k at 1200AD), alongside Yaroslav (3,5k), Sanok (2,5k) and Sambir (2,2k) [12]. North-east of the Dniester marshes, the Principality of Zvenyhorod centred on Zvenyhorod (a 45 ha citadel and waterlogged *posad* yielding Birch-Bark Letters Nos. 1-3, 10k at 1200AD) and Plisnesk (4,5k in 1200AD), before being superseded after c. 1256AD by Lviv (12k by 1300AD) [12][20]. Along the Seret and Middle Dniester, the Principality of Terebovlia was anchored by Terebovlia (30 ha, 6,5k at 1200AD), Vasyliv on the Dniester (35 ha with a white-stone church, 5k at 1200AD), Mykulyntsi (2,2k), Zbarazh (2k) and Onut (1,8k) [1][16].

In Volhynia and the southern borderlands, the Principality of Volhynia was governed from Volodymyr (*Vladimir-Volynsky*, a 75 ha rampart and *posad* complex around the 1160AD Mstislav Dormition Cathedral, 22k at 1200AD) and Kholm (*Chelm*, Daniel's royal capital from c. 1237AD, 36 ha, 8k at 1240AD and 12k at 1300AD), supported by the Western Bug strongholds of Cherven (3,5k), Ugrovesk (2,8k), Liuboml (2,5k), Vsevolozh (2,2k), Suteisk (2k) and Volyn (*Grudek*, 1,8k) [2][22]. Eastward across the Styr and Horyn basins, the Principality of Lutsk (1158-1324AD) centred on Lutsk (*Luchsk*, 40 ha, 10k at 1200AD), Peresopnytsia (24 ha, 5k), Dorogobuzh-on-Horyn (22 ha, 4,5k), Kremenets (20 ha, 4k), Iziaslavl (2,8k in 1200AD, whose burned 1241AD layer was excavated by M. K. Karger), Dubno (2,8k), Shumsk (2,8k), Ostroh (2,5k), Chortoryisk (2,2k), Danyliv (2k), Stepan (2k) and Peremyl (2k) [14][23]. On the Upper Bug, the Principality

of Belz (1171-1367AD) comprised Belz (28 ha, 6k at 1200AD), Busk (*Buzhsk*, 22 ha, 4k) and Sokal (1,8k) [12]. Further south, Ponizia (Podolia), Shipenitskaya Zemlya and Transcarpathia were anchored by Bakota (26 ha, 5,5k), Kamianets (22 ha, 4k), Medzhybizh (4k), Bozhsky (3,5k), Lenkivtsi (*Chern*) on the Prut (3,5k), Uzhhorod (*Ungvar*, 3,5k), Ushitsa (3k), Khotyn (3k), Kalius (2,5k), Mukachevo (2,5k) and Kuchelmin (2k), alongside the Pontic outposts of Tmutarakan (8k in 1050-1100AD) and Mangup (*Theodoro*, 6,5k in 1250-1300AD) [15][16].

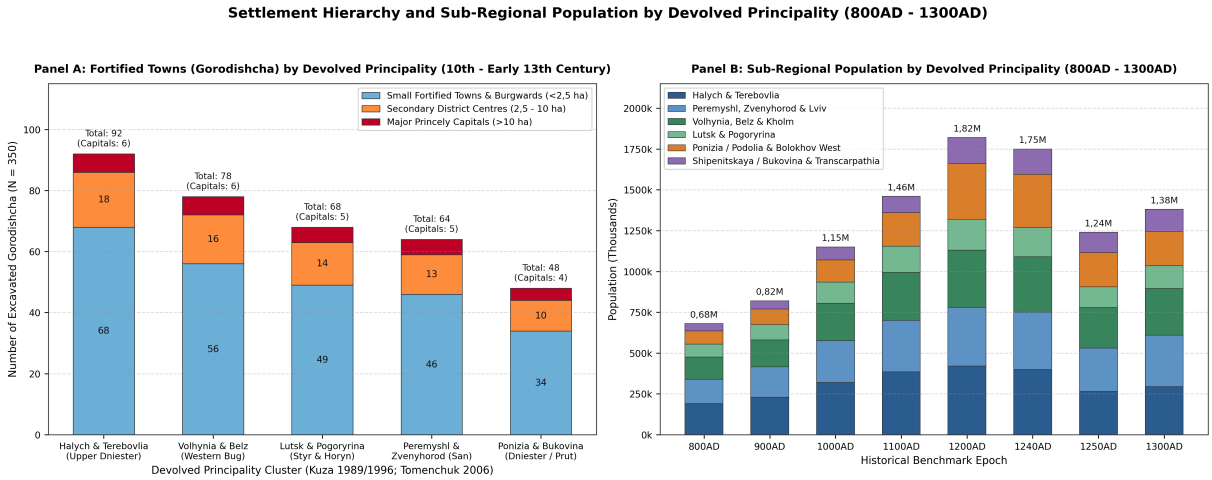


Figure 3. Left: distribution of the 350 excavated fortified settlements (gorodishcha) catalogued by Kuza and Tomenchuk across the five main provincial groups, distinguishing princely capitals (>10 ha), secondary district centres (2,5 - 10 ha) and small border forts (<2,5 ha). Right: sub-regional population shares from the Luka-Raikovetska tribal era (800AD) to the post-Mongol recovery under King Daniel and Lev Danilovich (1300AD).

Mongol Invasion and the Kingdom of Rus

On the eve of Batu Khan's western campaign (1240AD), the unified Romanovichi realm supported 1,75M inhabitants, down slightly from the 1,82M peak of 1200AD after the boyar and Hungarian wars of succession (1205-1238AD). During the winter campaign of December 1240 - March 1241, Mongol armies stormed and burned Iziaslavl, Kolodyazhyn, Volodymyr, Halych, Zvenyhorod, Peresopnytsia and Terebovlia, reducing the regional population to 1,24M in 1250AD (-31,9% below 1200AD) [11][23]. Because the cliff fortresses of Kremenets and Danyliv, the new royal capital at Kholm, Bakota in Ponizia and the Carpathian mountain valleys survived intact, King Daniel Romanovich (crowned *Rex Russiae* at Dorohychyn in 1253AD), Vasilko Romanovich, Lev Danilovich (who made Lviv the main capital in 1272AD) and Yuri I Lvovich led a recovery in both countryside and towns across the Kingdom of Rus, reaching 1,38M by 1300AD [1][12][22].

Date	Halych & Terebovlia	Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod & Lviv	Volhynia, Belz & Kholm	Principality of Lutsk	Ponizia, Bolokhov, Bukovina & Transcarpathia	Regional Total
1000AD	320k	255k	230k	130k	215k	1,15M
1100AD	385k	315k	295k	160k	305k	1,46M
1150AD	405k	340k	325k	175k	405k	1,65M
1200AD	420k	360k	350k	190k	500k	1,82M

1240AD	400k	350k	340k	180k	480k	1,75M
1250AD	265k	265k	250k	125k	335k	1,24M
1300AD	295k	315k	285k	140k	345k	1,38M

Table 2. Population by principality (in thousands) from the incorporation of the Cherven towns under Vladimir the Great (1000AD) through the 1200AD appanage peak and the 1240-1241AD Mongol sack to the recovery of the Kingdom of Rus in 1300AD.

Comparison with Other Rus Principalities

Table 3 compares the population of Galicia and Volhynia with the northern and eastern Rus principalities between 1000AD and 1300AD [3][8][21].

Principality / Region	1000AD Pop.	1100AD Pop.	1200AD Peak	1250AD Low	1300AD Pop.
Galician Principalities (Halych, Peremyshl, Zvenyhorod, Terebovlia)	575k	700k	780k	530k	610k
Volhynian Principalities (Volodymyr, Kholm, Lutsk, Belz)	360k	455k	540k	375k	425k
Ponizia (Podolia), Bolokhov West, Bukovina & Transcarpathia	215k	305k	500k	335k	345k
Galicia and Volhynia Subtotal	1,15M	1,46M	1,82M	1,24M	1,38M
cf. Vladimir-Suzdal/Rostov (European Russia)	340k	510k	780k	520k	640k
cf. Novgorod & Pskov Republics (European Russia)	290k	380k	480k	460k	510k
cf. Principality of Smolensk (European Russia)	210k	275k	340k	290k	310k
cf. Total European Russia Benchmark	2,15M	2,9M	3,85M	2,8M	3,1M

Table 3. Population of the Galician, Volhynian and Podolian principalities compared with Vladimir-Suzdal, Novgorod-Pskov and Smolensk, 1000AD - 1300AD. Before the Mongol invasion of 1240AD, South-Western Rus held roughly half as many inhabitants as all of northern and eastern European Russia combined.

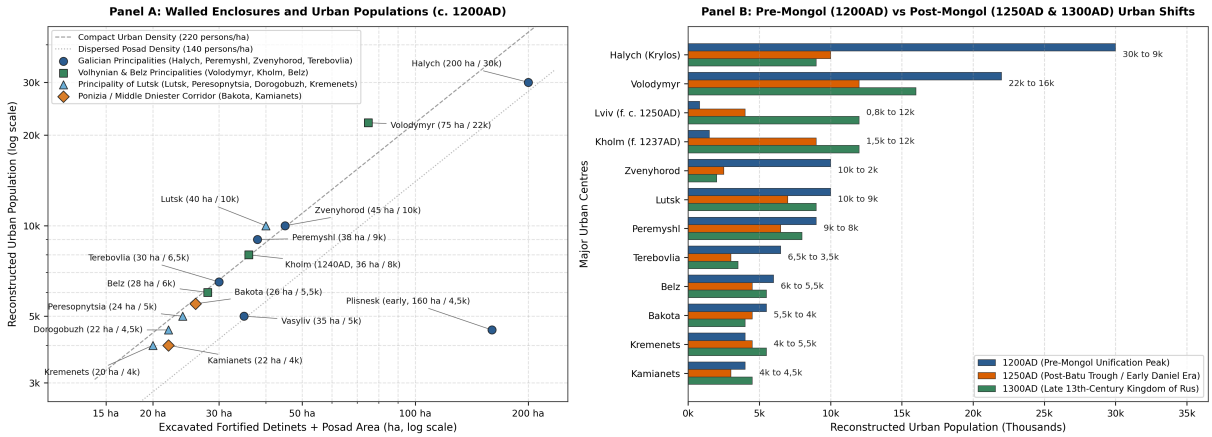


Figure 4. Left: fortified citadel (detinets) and suburb (posad) areas plotted against urban population in 1200AD, contrasting compact multi-rampart towns (200 - 290 persons/ha at Volodymyr, Zvenyhorod and Lutsk) with sprawling river-terrace enclosures (140 - 150 persons/ha at Halych and Vasyliv). Right: the shift in urban population between 1200AD and 1300AD from the sacked older capitals of Halych and Zvenyhorod to the new royal seats at Kholm and Lviv.

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